

Lake Nakuru

East Central Africa



Location Kenya

Area 15 sq miles (40 sq km)

Maximum depth 10 ft (3 m)

Elevation 5,780 ft (1,760 m) above sea level

This shallow lake lies in Africa's Great Rift Valley, where the heat constantly evaporates the water, concentrating dissolved minerals to create a soda lake with a high level of sodium carbonate. The very alkaline water supports specialized microbes that are eaten by dazzling flocks of flamingos. It is one of several lakes that lie in the Rift Valley, including the very deep Lake Malawi.

► PINK FLOCKS

Colored proteins in their diet of plankton give flamingos their beautiful pink plumage.



WATER



Crater Lake

North America



Location Oregon

Area 21 sq miles (53 sq km)

Maximum depth 1,934 ft (589 m)

Elevation 8,159 ft (2,487 m) above sea level

Famous for its clear, deep blue water, Crater Lake lies within a dormant volcano called Mount Mazama. After an eruption about 7,700 years ago, the peak collapsed into the empty magma chamber to form a broad caldera. This is flooded with rainwater, and is very pure because there are no streams carrying impurities into the lake.

Lake Titicaca

Andes, South America



Location Bolivia-Peru border

Area 3,386 sq miles (8,772 sq km)

Maximum depth 923 ft (281 m)

Elevation 12,516 ft (3,812 m) above sea level

Lying high in the Andes between Bolivia and Peru, this is the highest large lake in the world and the largest lake in South America. It is fed by more than 20 rivers flowing off the surrounding mountains. Some parts of the shore have dense beds

of totora reeds, which the local people use to make boats and even floating villages.

▼ FLOATING VILLAGE

Titicaca has more than 40 islands. Some of them are artificial, built using the totora reed.

